

ELA Practice Worksheet

Reading ? Vocabulary ? Grammar ? Writing

Name: _____ Date: _____ Class: _____

Instructions: Read the passage carefully, then complete each section. Write in complete sentences where asked. Use the back of the page if you need more room.

Part 1: Reading Comprehension

Passage: "The Light in the Tower"

Maya had always believed the old lighthouse at the edge of her town was abandoned. Every evening she watched it from her bedroom window, its windows dark, its paint peeling, its door sealed shut by decades of rust and neglect. So when, on the night of the storm, a single steady light blinked to life at the top of the tower, Maya sat up in bed and stared.

The next morning, she walked the muddy path to the cliff. The lighthouse loomed above her, silent again, as though she had imagined it. But there, tucked beneath the door, was a small notebook wrapped in plastic. Inside, in careful handwriting, someone had written: "If you found this, the keeper has been waiting a long time for company. Come back tomorrow at sunset."

Maya closed the notebook. Her heart beat quickly, but not with fear. For the first time in months, she felt curious about something - truly, wildly curious.

Answer the questions below in complete sentences.

1. Where does the story take place, and why is the setting important?

2. What evidence from the passage shows that Maya thought the lighthouse was abandoned?

3. How does Maya's feeling change from the beginning of the passage to the end? Use a quote to support your answer.

4. Predict: what do you think Maya will find when she returns at sunset? Use at least one detail from the text.

Part 2: Vocabulary

A. Match each word to its meaning by writing the correct letter on the line.

- | | | |
|--------------|-------|---|
| 1. abandoned | _____ | A. appeared large, tall, or threatening |
| 2. neglect | _____ | B. left empty or unused; deserted |
| 3. loomed | _____ | C. a person who looks after or guards something |
| 4. curious | _____ | D. failure to take care of something |
| 5. keeper | _____ | E. eager to learn or know something |

B. Fill in the blank with the best word from Part A. (Use each word only once.)

1. After years of _____, the old barn was full of dust and broken tools.
2. The tall trees _____ above the hikers as they walked through the forest.
3. A zoo _____ knows the name and habits of every animal in their care.
4. The _____ warehouse had not been used by anyone for nearly a decade.
5. Alex was so _____ about the experiment that she stayed after class to ask questions.

Part 3: Grammar & Mechanics

A. Underline the nouns, circle the verbs, and draw a box around the adjectives in each sentence.

1. The small dog barked loudly at the mail carrier.
2. Yesterday, our teacher carefully explained the difficult problem.
3. The bright, cheerful students sang a beautiful song.

B. Rewrite each sentence with correct capitalization and punctuation.

1. where did you put my book asked jordan

2. we visited london paris and rome last summer

3. although it was raining we still went to the park

4. mrs garcia my science teacher grew up in mexico city

Part 4: Writing Prompt

Imagine you are Maya. Write a one-paragraph journal entry (5-7 sentences) describing what happens when you return to the lighthouse at sunset. Include at least two sensory details (what you see, hear, smell, feel, or taste) and one line of dialogue.

Teacher note: An answer key is on the final page. Remove before distributing to students.

Answer Key (Teacher Copy)

Part 1: Reading Comprehension (sample responses)

1. The story takes place in Maya's town, near an old lighthouse on a cliff. The setting matters because the lighthouse is the mysterious place that sparks the plot.
2. The windows were dark, the paint was peeling, and the door was "sealed shut by decades of rust and neglect."
3. Maya begins passive and bored ("just watching" from her window). By the end she feels "truly, wildly curious," showing she has become engaged and excited.
4. Accept any reasonable prediction supported by textual evidence (e.g., the notebook, the lit tower, the mention of a "keeper").

Part 2A: Matching

1. abandoned - B 2. neglect - D 3. loomed - A 4. curious - E 5. keeper - C

Part 2B: Fill-in

1. neglect 2. loomed 3. keeper 4. abandoned 5. curious

Part 3A: Parts of speech (key words)

1. Nouns: dog, mail carrier. Verb: barked. Adjective: small.
2. Noun: teacher, problem. Verb: explained. Adjective: difficult (adverbs: yesterday, carefully).
3. Nouns: students, song. Verb: sang. Adjectives: bright, cheerful, beautiful.

Part 3B: Corrected sentences

1. "Where did you put my book?" asked Jordan.
2. We visited London, Paris, and Rome last summer.
3. Although it was raining, we still went to the park.
4. Mrs. Garcia, my science teacher, grew up in Mexico City.

Part 4: Writing Prompt

Accept any on-topic paragraph that (a) is written from Maya's first-person perspective, (b) includes at least two sensory details, and (c) contains at least one line of dialogue punctuated correctly.